Microorganisms as consumers

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the passage below.

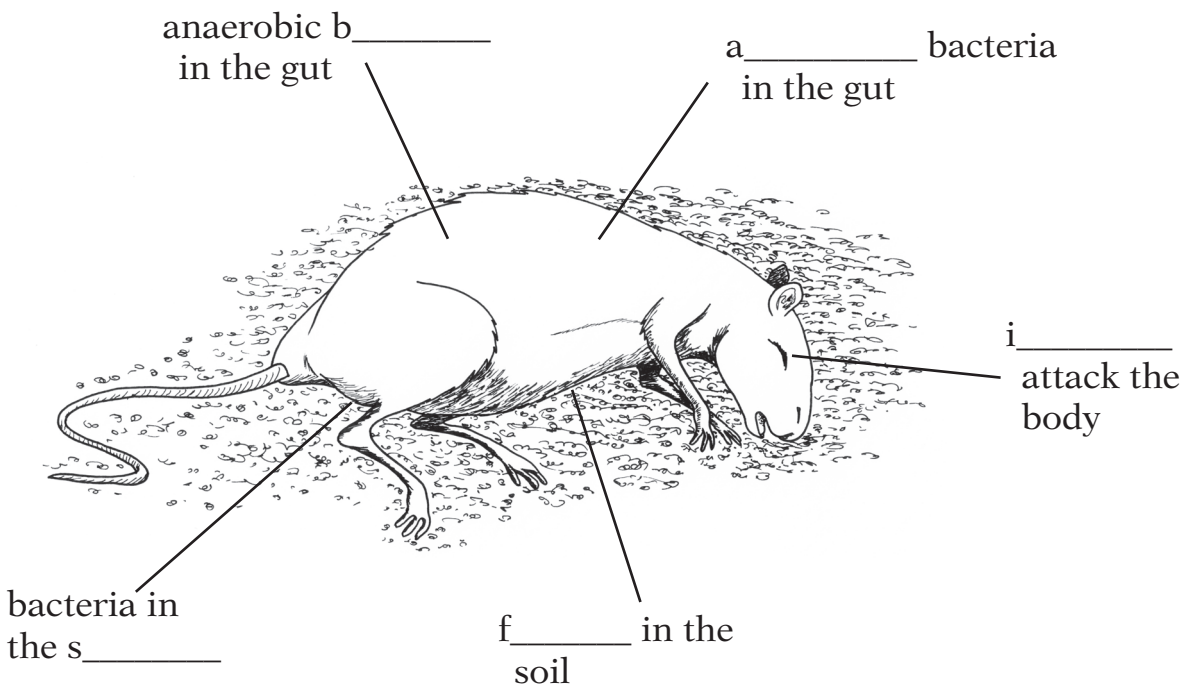
Word bank					
flies	gas	fungi	microorganisms	oxygen	Ants
bloat	rotting	**aerobic**	bacteria	decomposition	carcass

When an animal dies, m_____ (mainly bacteria and fungi) start consuming the carcass. Firstly, a_____ bacteria inside the animal start to feed and multiply using what o_____ is available. Their activity produces lots of g_____, making the carcass expand, or b_____. When the available oxygen is used up, **anaerobic** b_____ take over. Bacteria and f_____ in the air and soil also start to consume the c_____.

Insects such as ants and f_____ also take part in d_____. A_____ eat the dead tissue. Flies lay their eggs in the r_____ flesh, which the young maggots eat.

2 Use these words to complete the labels on the diagram.

insects	soil	bacteria	fungi	aerobic



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